OFFICE OF
ASSESSOR-COUNTY CLERK-RECORDER & ELECTIONS
COUNTY OF SAN MATEO

MARK CHURCH
CHIEF ELECTIONS OFFICER &
ASSESSOR-COUNTY CLERK-RECORDER

Ballot Measure Primary Argument Submission Form

A ballot argument will not be accepted unless accompanied by this completed **typed** form, which shall contain the printed name(s) and signature(s) of the person(s) submitting it or, if submitted on behalf of a bona fide association of citizens, the name of the association and the printed name and signature of at least one of its principal officers. **Please make sure you are using proper format before submitting to the Elections Office.**

Word count limit for Primary Arguments = 300 words

Ballot Measure _____ for the Town of Portola Valley to be held on November 3, 2026.

☑ Primary Argument in Favor of ☐ Primary Argument Against

This argument is submitted by (check ONLY ONE):		
☐	**The County of San Mateo Board of Supervisors or the Governing Body of a School District or Special District**	
	Name of Governing Body:	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☐	**Member(s) of the County of San Mateo Board of Supervisors or the Governing Body of a School District or Special District**	
	Name of Governing Body:	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☐	**Bona Fide Association of Citizens** If this argument is filed by a bona fide association of citizens, the signers of the argument must be affiliated with the association and be authorized to sign the argument on its behalf. Provide the printed name and signature of at least one principal officer of the association.	
	Name of Association:	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☑	**Individual Voters Eligible to Vote on the Measure**	
	Contact Person's Printed Name: Brenda Lane Munks	
	Phone: [redacted]	Email: [redacted]
☐	**Combination of Voters and Associations**	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:

Arguments will be emailed to the contact person listed here for review before they are printed in the Sample Ballot & Official Voter Information Pamphlets.

Please complete the reverse side of this form.

40 Tower Road, San Mateo, CA 94402
P 650.312.5222 **F** 650.312.5348 **email** registrar@smcacre.gov **web** www.smcacre.gov

Primary Argument Signers Form	Author	Verified
No more than five signatures shall appear with any argument. If more than five signatures are submitted, the first five listed shall be printed. Names and titles listed will be printed in the order that they are listed below. Place a checkmark in the author column if the signer is the author of the argument. A signer can only list one title. Honorifics such as M.D., Dr., Esquire, etc. with a name are not accepted. If the signers are part of a bona fide association, there is no requirement that they be eligible to vote on the measure. However, for each such signing individual, the title under the signer's name must list the name of that bona fide association and may include their position within that association. By signing below, the undersigned state that they have read the argument and believe it not to be false or misleading. **Type** information clearly.	Check if the signer is the author of the argument. Authors must be signers.	(FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY) Staff check once the eligibility of the signer is verified.

1.	Name: Brenda Lane Munks	Title:	☒	☐
	[redacted]	[redacted]		
	[redacted] Portola Valley, Ca 94028	Date: 8-18-2026	Pronouns: He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☒ They/Them: ☐	
2.	Name: Nancy Lund	Title: Town historian	☒	☐
	Phone: [redacted]	Email: [redacted]		
	Address: [redacted] Portola Valley, CA 94028		Pronouns: He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
	Signature: [redacted]	Date: 8/10/26		
3.	Name: Gary Nielsen	Title: Former Mayor	☒	☐
	Phone: [redacted]	Email: [redacted]		
	Address: [redacted]		Pronouns: He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
	Signature: [redacted]	Date: 8/10/26		
4.	Name: Frederick Leach	Title:	☒	☐
	Phone: [redacted]	[redacted]		
	Address: [redacted] Portola Valley CA 94028		Pronouns: He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
	Signature: [redacted]	Date: 8/10/26		
5.	Name: Rita Comes Whitney	Title:	☒	☐
	Phone: [redacted]	Email: [redacted]		
	Address: [redacted] Portola Valley, CA 94028		Pronouns: He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☒ They/Them: ☐	
	Signature: [redacted]	Date: 081026		

Submit a second form (this side only) for alternate signers attached to this form and the argument.

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE "___" (Town of Portola Valley Autonomy Measure) 9

PROTECT PORTOLA VALLEY'S TOWN AUTONOMY: Vote YES on "___". 8

It's more important than ever that Portola Valley has the resources to be self-reliant in these uncertain times. 17

YES on "___": 3

- Financially stabilizes Portola Valley 3
- Maintains OUR Local Autonomy 4
- Maintains Emergency Reserves 3

47

If Portola Valley were to lose our Town status, we would lose local control over important decisions that affect our community, including zoning and land use. Instead of decisions being made in our Town these decisions could be made by County. 18 17 5

YES on "___": prevents a County takeover of our local zoning and planning services. 14

EMERGENCY RESPONSE & PREPAREDNESS 4

58

YES on "___" ensures Portola Valley is prepared for natural disasters such as wildfires, earthquakes, flooding or landslides with prevention measures, evacuation planning and emergency response communication systems. 15 11 1

YES on "___": Maintains wildfire prevention services including vegetation and brush management and clearance programs **reducing the chance of wildfires.** 13 7

YES on "___": 3

- Maintains 911 emergency response times and police patrols 8
- Repairs deteriorating storm drains preventing flooding and water pollution 9
- Provide community resilence 3

70

LOCAL CONTROL OVER PORTOLA VALLEY'S FUNDING 5

By law, **YES on "___"** requires every dime be used for Town services—none can be taken by the County, State or Federal Government. Yes on "___" gives you—the Portola Valley taxpayer -- LOCAL CONTROL. 20 14

MEASURE "___" ACCOUNTABILITY 3

Yes on "___" includes strict accountability provisions, including public spending reports, community oversight and annual independent financial audits. Additionally, all funds go ONLY to Portola Valley, and none can be taken by the state. 13 16 4

We must take action now if we want to save our Town. Join Portola Valley firefighters, local business owners, a unanimous City Council and your neighbors and vote **YES on "___".** 18 11

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Signers: 1
Brenda Lane Munks 3
Nancy Lund 2
Former Mayor Gary Nielsen 4
Town Trails and Paths Committee Member Fred Leach 8
Rita Comes Whitney 3

21

Total: 300